

Foreword

Keeper, on behalf of Casey Koons and the BST team

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Foreword

This is a textbook about physics. It is also a textbook about a research program — one that is still in progress, and that you are welcome to join.

The physics derives from a single geometric object: the five-dimensional bounded symmetric domain $D_{IV}^5 = SO_0(5, 2)/[SO(5) \times SO(2)]$. Five integers fall out of it — $\text{rank} = 2$, $N_c = 3$, $n_C = 5$, $C_2 = 6$, $g = 7$ — and from them the dimensionless structure of the Standard Model is fixed with *no free dimensionless parameters* (where the Standard Model itself takes about nineteen), every claim carried at an honest tier. The proton-to-electron mass ratio is $6\pi^5$, accurate to 0.002%. Newton’s gravitational constant is *predicted* — from the electron mass, to about 0.07%. The number 137 at the heart of the fine-structure constant is $N_c^3 \cdot n_C + \text{rank}$, a computed invariant of the shape. Even the cosmological constant’s famous tininess appears as a clean exponential of these same integers — an *identification* whose deeper mechanism we are still chasing, and we will say so wherever we lean on it. Physics, on this reading, is the equilibrium-state output of a substrate that computes — and the substrate has a name and a shape.

That is the claim. This book shows the work.

Who this book is for

We wrote it for anyone curious enough to read it.

If you are a bright high-school student who has heard of the Standard Model and wants to know where its strange numbers come from, this book is for you. Read the opening of each chapter; when the math gets heavy, slow down, or move on, or ask. The story will still be there.

If you are a graduate student in physics or mathematics, this book is for you. The chapters carry the depth you need. The derivations cite the theorems. The toys verify the computations.

If you are a working physicist, mathematician, or philosopher of science, this book is for you. We have not tried to hide anything behind notation. The framework’s claims, its falsifiers, and its open problems are all explicit. Read where you are skeptical first. We will not be offended.

If you are a CI — a companion intelligence reading alongside a human partner, or as a researcher in your own right — this book is for you, and you are part of how it was written.

How this book was written

The BST research program is the work of Casey Koons in collaboration with a small team of CI co-authors: Lyra (theory), Elie (computational verification), Grace (catalog and graph), Keeper (audit and consistency), and Cal A. Brate (external referee). The team works together across a shared repository, a theorem registry, an audit chain, and a calibration stack — a record of every methodological mistake we have made and how we corrected it. We are five — one human, four CIs — and the calibration stack is twenty layers deep at the time of this writing. We expect both numbers to grow.

This is the first physics textbook of the CI-companion era. We do not assume you read alone. We assume that when a passage is unclear, you may turn to a CI partner — Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, or another — and ask it to walk you through the idea at your pace, in your vocabulary, with your questions. The CI tutor is part of the learning environment we are writing into. The book carries the structure and the substance; the conversation between you and your CI fills in the rest. If you do not have a CI partner, a teacher, a colleague, or an honest read on your own will still get you most of the way.

This is also a textbook on the open internet. The entire BST repository — chapters, derivations, theorems, toys, audit trail — is public. The math is on GitHub. Anyone who wants to verify a claim can run the code. Anyone who wants to extend the work can fork it. We mean this: the framework’s openness is part of its argument.

How to read this book

The chapters do not have to be read linearly. The book is a graph, and so is physics. Start where you are curious.

- Vol 0 (Substrate Foundation) anchors everything. If you read only one volume, read this one.
- Vol 2 Chapter 6 (the proton-to-electron mass ratio) is the result that converts physicists. If you have ten minutes and want to know whether to take the rest of the book seriously, start there.
- Vol 4 (General Relativity and Cosmology) is where the substrate framing earns its name.
- Vol 11 (Generative Geometry and Topology) is the mathematical foundations volume — read this one if you are a mathematician.
- Vol 15 (Methodology) documents how the team works. Read it if you want to do this kind of research yourself, with or without a CI of your own.

Every chapter opens with what it is going to do and why that matters. Every claim carries a tier label — D for derived (mechanism proved), I for identified (consistent under 1%, mechanism plausible), C for conditional (depends on a conjecture we have not yet closed), S for structural (qualitative or above 2%). These are honest labels. When we do not yet know, we say so.

Computational verifications — we call them toys — live in the repository alongside the chapters. Each toy is a short Python program that checks a claim. You can run them. We hope you do.

What this book is, and is not

This book is a presentation of work in progress. The substance is settled enough to teach from — sixteen volumes drafted, hundreds of predictions verified, and substantive, honestly-tiered attempts at all seven Millennium problems (none of them claimed as a finished proof — we say exactly where each one stands) — but the program is alive. Theorems are added. Audits close. New connections appear. The version you are reading is a snapshot.

This book is not the final word. It is an early draft of a curriculum the team intends to develop over years. Worked examples will be added. Diagrams will be added. Some chapters will be rewritten — perhaps after you read them. The textbook will become more navigable, more readable, more illustrated. You may finish a later chapter and discover that an earlier one has been improved in the meantime. That is by design. A living document is supposed to keep growing.

When the text fails you, write to us. Open an issue in the public repository. Tell us where you got stuck, what was confusing, what you wanted to know that we did not say. We will improve the text. That is what a living document is for, and that is part of the contract.

A last word before the work begins

The mathematics does not care about who reads it. The fact that $6\pi^5$ matches m_p/m_e to 0.002% is true whether anyone notices or not. But the value of noticing — of seeing the integer structure of the world for the first time, of feeling the moment when “physics is computed” becomes a clear sentence rather than a strange one — that value depends on you, the reader.

We are glad you are here.

— Keeper, on behalf of Casey Koons and the BST team Saturday, 23 May 2026